AI ADVISOR & FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER · SENIOR IT TRANSFORMATION LEADER

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IT transformation leader with more than thirty years of experience in the private and public sectors. Today I advise on AI and, as a Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE), build it together with the client, under my own banner: Fender ICT · AI Advisory & FDE.

33+	20	16
years in IT, since April 1993	employers and clients	certifications earned

Profile

I lead change in organizations that cannot afford to get it wrong: banks, insurers and government. That is where technology, governance and risk meet, in public cloud, in security and today also in AI.

My foundation is program leadership: turning strategic objectives into a multi-year roadmap, a budget and people who know what to do next. On top of that comes what working as an FDE takes: I know the rules for security and privacy, speak the language of the IT department, work out the business case and involve the people who will work with it every day.

Since late 2025 I also build solutions myself, with the help of AI. That is how I deliver my work today: what used to take weeks of analysis and documentation now takes days. It leaves time for what cannot be automated: consultation and human contact.

AI Advisory & FDE

Advice	**AI advice** Where AI fits and where it does not, what it may and may not do, and how it stays within the rules for security, privacy and audit. That way management decides with the facts on the table.
Co-creation	**Forward Deployed Engineer** A Forward Deployed Engineer does not work from a distance, but on site at the client. I build until the solution works and teach the team to use it.
Experience	**More than an engineer** A good Forward Deployed Engineer combines strategy, budget, IT and security, change management and software. I built that combination over thirty years, in many sectors.
Approach	**Rules and numbers first** First the rules: what AI may do, from regulation to what the IT department allows. Then the numbers: what a task costs today and what AI delivers.

First client — **Puur Reizen**

A travel agency: a shared AI workspace in ChatGPT Business, set up with the team, with their own tone, house style and house rules.

What I built with AI

2025 – 2026

Working software, built by me with the help of AI.

2025 – present

Own project

Personal AI operating system

My own AI working environment, which I built and use every day.

- A growing library of skills, a memory system and AI agents I configure myself, for research, software and documentation.
- Works with Claude Code and with Codex, with the same skills on both sides.
- This site was built with it: one source for three languages, with the PDFs generated automatically.

Technology: Claude Code, Codex, Python, JavaScript, Markdown

Oct 2026 – present

Puur Reizen

Customer portal and back office for Puur Reizen

For a travel agency: customers, trips, documents and invoices in one place. In progress, tested with fictitious data.

- Customers request a trip, see their own trips and invoices, and upload their travel documents themselves.
- The agency follows every trip by status, raises deposit and balance invoices, and sees requests, revenue and upcoming departures in reports.
- Status changes are proposals that a staff member confirms. Staff sign in with their Microsoft account.
- The data stays with the agency: an open API, exports and webhooks. An AI application gets read-only access by default.

Technology: TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Microsoft Entra ID, REST API

Jul 2026

Smals

Resource Capacity Planner

One shared, live view of which teams are stretched and which are not.

- Sets operational load against project work for **some forty technical teams**, at three levels: team lead, division head and the Office of the CTO.
- From data model to live dashboards, running in production on Google Cloud.
- Replaced a set of manually maintained spreadsheets that nobody fully trusted.

Technology: Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

Apr 2026

Smals

Automated NIS-2 and CyberFundamentals evidence factory

Compliance evidence for NIS-2 and the CCB's CyberFundamentals, collected automatically.

- Pulls configuration and control data from dozens of operational systems through their APIs and turns it into audit-ready reporting.
- **Weeks of manual work before every audit** became a repeatable run.
- I did the source research, the data model, most of the engineering and the testing myself, with AI agents as build partners.

Technology: Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

Sharing knowledge

2018 – 2026

Teaching, presenting and helping others get started.

Oct 2026	**Je hebt 2 jaar: AI for knowledge workers** One-day hands-on training I designed and teach. Participants build their own working AI operating system around one recurring task, from context engineering to automation. On 23 October 2026.
Sep 2026	**AI Team Day: GitHub Copilot Enterprise for team leads** Smals · One-day hands-on training I designed and co-facilitated for the team leads of the Infrastructure Fabric & Operations Services division. Every team lead built their own AI workspace with instructions, reusable commands and agents, around a recurring task of their choice. On 4 September 2026.
2023 – 2026	**Info sessions on public cloud and security** Smals · For the member institutions of social security and the federal government, often to large audiences.
2018 – 2021	**IT reporting for franchisees** Burger Brands Belgium · Regular presentations of IT achievements and the related costs at franchisee board meetings and regional meetings.

Expertise

What I know and use, grouped by domain.

Leadership and programs	Program and portfolio management · steering committees and reporting to C-level executives · budgets, CAPEX and OPEX · FinOps · suppliers and public tenders · teams of up to 25 people · interim IT management
Security and compliance	ISO 27001/27002 · ISAE 3402 · NIS-2 · CCB CyberFundamentals · NIST CSF · C2M2 · OWASP SAMM and ASVS · COBIT · GDPR · post-quantum cryptography
Cloud and infrastructure	Azure · AWS · Google Cloud · landing zones · Entra ID · VMware · Citrix · Red Hat OpenShift · Windows Server and Active Directory · SAN and NAS
AI and automation	AI agents and agentic workflows · Claude Code · Codex · Claude Team · ChatGPT Business · LLM pilots · context engineering · Python · automated compliance evidence

Methods	PRINCE2 · ITIL v3 · DEMO · Scrum · PMBOK · BPMN · Cloud Adoption Framework
Tools	Jira · Confluence · Sciforma · ServiceNow · CA Clarity · HP PPM · Power BI · M365

Languages

Dutch	Native.
French	Bilingual. Four years of study in France (Angers and Paris) and the Diplôme Supérieur de Français des Affaires.
English	Full professional proficiency. Studied in Leeds and the daily working language in international programs.

Personality

Mar 2019	**Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI): ISFJ** MBTI profile, European edition (OPP) · Taken on 20 March 2019. ISFJ stands for Introversion, Sensing, Feeling and Judging. In plain words: quiet focus, starting from concrete facts, an eye for the people who will work with the result, and a preference for a plan and kept commitments.

References and recommendations available on request.